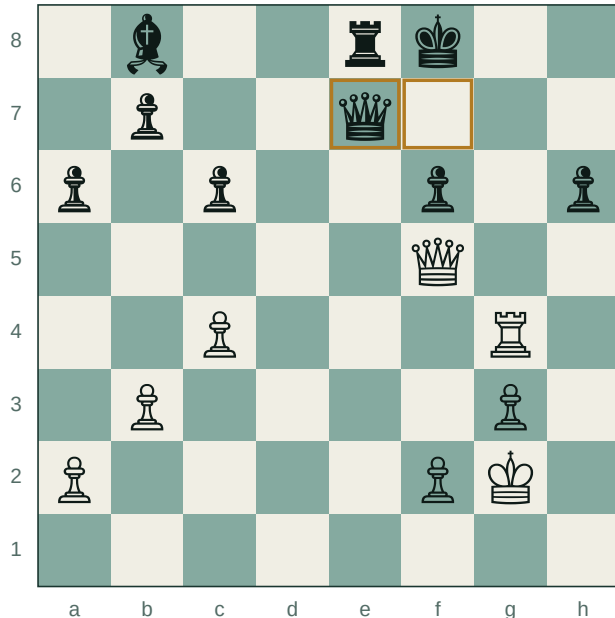


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 35

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 34...Qe7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Qg6 Qf7 36. Qxh6+ Ke7 37. Rg7

35.Qg6 The queen moves from f5 to g6. Recorded reply: **35...Qf7**.

36.Qxh6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h6. Recorded reply: **36...Ke7**.

37.Rg7 The rook moves from g4 to g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -3 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on f8. Absolute pin: pawn on f6.